

The willow knows

I ask the old willow where I might rest
and her heavy branches beckon me.

She lets me drop my head in a nook
between her criss-crossed roots,
as the breeze brushes my hair.

Her birds—despite their habit—
sing sweet lullabies
to eyes droopy like the watchful tree.

The soil bed cradles as I settle,
molding to fit my bones
as if it had always remembered.

Grass and flowers shroud me in plush,
welcoming worms and ants
who snuggle against my skin.

At last, I might find sleep.
The willow knows, the willow knows.